

Psalms 108

My Heart Is Fixed

O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise, even with my glory
KJV · Standalone study handout

1 · THE WORD (KJV)

- 1 O God, my heart is fixed; I will sing and give praise, even with my glory.
- 2 Awake, psaltery and harp: I myself will awake early.
- 3 I will praise thee, O LORD, among the people: and I will sing praises unto thee among the nations.
- 4 For thy mercy is great above the heavens: and thy truth reacheth unto the clouds.
- 5 Be thou exalted, O God, above the heavens: and thy glory above all the earth;
- 6 That thy beloved may be delivered: save with thy right hand, and answer me.
- 7 God hath spoken in his holiness; I will rejoice, I will divide Shechem, and mete out the valley of Succoth.
- 8 Gilead is mine; Manasseh is mine; Ephraim also is the strength of mine head; Judah is my lawgiver;
- 9 Moab is my washpot; over Edom will I cast out my shoe; over Philistia will I triumph.
- 10 Who will bring me into the strong city? who will lead me into Edom?
- 11 Wilt not thou, O God, who hast cast us off? and wilt not thou, O God, go forth with our hosts?
- 12 Give us help from trouble: for vain is the help of man.
- 13 Through God we shall do valiantly: for he it is that shall tread down our enemies.

2 · CONTEXT

Psalm 108 combines material found separately in Psalms 57 and 60 into a single confident declaration of praise and territorial hope, opening with resolved devotion before moving into oracle-like claims over specific regions and a closing acknowledgment that human help alone is insufficient. Henry notes the psalm's opening resolve—"my heart is fixed"—as the necessary foundation for everything that follows: settled devotion precedes both bold praise and bold requests.

3 · VERSE-BY-VERSE COMMENTARY

The notes below cover the whole chapter in one place—read with the KJV text above.

Verse 1-4

The psalm opens with resolved devotion: my heart is fixed, O God, I will sing and give praise even with my glory. Instruments are called to awake, and the psalmist himself commits to waking early to praise among the peoples and nations, grounded in God's mercy, described as great above the heavens, and truth reaching to the clouds.

Verse 5-6

A brief, urgent petition follows: be exalted, O God, above the heavens, and let Your glory be above all the earth, so that Your beloved may be delivered—save with Your right hand, and answer.

Verse 7-13

God's own oracle is recalled, dividing and naming specific territories—Shechem, the valley of Succoth, Gilead, Manasseh, Ephraim as the strength of His head, Judah as lawgiver—alongside a more adversarial claim over Moab, Edom, and Philistia. The psalmist then asks who will lead into the strong city and into Edom, admitting honestly that God appears, from present experience, to have cast them off; the conclusion follows plainly—help from man is worthless, but through God real victory is possible, treading down enemies not by human strength alone.

4 · MEANING & APPLICATION

Meaning.

Settled, resolved devotion to God—"my heart is fixed"—is the necessary starting point for bold praise, bold territorial hope, and honest petition alike; without that fixed foundation, confidence in any of the rest would be unstable. The psalm's honest admission that human help is ultimately worthless, paired with confidence that God can still act decisively, models dependence that neither despairs nor over-relies on human strength.

Application for life today.

Before moving into whatever request or ambition is on your heart today, take verse 1 literally and settle your own devotion first—"my heart is fixed"—rather than praying from a scattered or divided state. Notice the honest tension in verses 11–12: real

acknowledgment that circumstances look discouraging, held together with real confidence that God can still act; let your own prayers include both. Examine where you are currently relying on human help alone (v. 12) for something that actually requires God's intervention.

5 • REFLECT & RESPOND

Write your answers in the space below. There are no “right length” answers—honesty before God is the aim.

1. What would it mean, practically, to settle your own heart—'fixed,' as verse 1 says—before bringing today's requests to God, rather than praying from scattered attention?

2. How does holding honest discouragement (v. 11) together with real confidence in God's power (v. 13) in the same short psalm model something you need in a current situation?

3. Where are you currently relying on 'the help of man' alone (v. 12) for something that actually requires God's intervention?

Name: _____ Date: _____ Group / Church: _____

Sources: King James Version (public domain); Matthew Henry, Commentary on the Whole Bible (themes summarized); Expository themes consistent with MacArthur Study Bible tradition (paraphrased, not quoted). Scripture: King James Version (public domain).